

Employing in Poland

What You Need to Know · Employment Hero HeroForce EOR · July 2026

What does the EOR handle for you?

- **Employment contracts** — compliant contracts under the Polish Labour Code
- **Monthly payroll** — salary payments in PLN, itemised payslips
- **Tax withholding** — PIT calculated using the "kwota wolna" tax-free allowance and remitted monthly
- **ZUS & NFZ** — social security and national health fund contributions
- **Leave and termination management** — notice periods, entitlements and severance guidance

Employment Conditions

Contracts & Probation

The Polish Labour Code permits a probationary contract (umowa na okres próbny) as a distinct, time-limited contract type before moving to a fixed-term or indefinite contract.

Item	Detail	Legal Basis
Probationary contract	Maximum 3 months (can vary slightly with planned fixed-term length)	Polish Labour Code
Fixed-term contracts	Maximum 33 months / 3 contracts, then converts to indefinite	Polish Labour Code

Working Hours & Overtime

Rule	Detail	Authority
Standard hours	8 hrs/day, 40 hrs/week	Polish Labour Code
Overtime premium (nights/rest days/holidays)	200% of hourly rate	Polish Labour Code
Overtime premium (other overtime)	150% of hourly rate	Polish Labour Code

Minimum Wage & ZUS Contributions (2026)

Measure	Rate	Notes
Minimum wage	PLN 4,806/month	Effective 2026; minimum hourly rate for mandate contracts PLN 31.40
Employer ZUS contribution	~19.2%–22.4% of gross salary	Pension 9.76%, disability 6.5%, accident 0.67%–3.33% (industry-dependent), Labour Fund 2.45%, Guaranteed Benefits Fund 0.1%
Employee ZUS contribution	13.71% of gross salary	Pension 9.76%, disability 1.5%, sickness 2.45%
Employee NFZ health contribution	9% of assessment base (gross minus employee ZUS)	Not deductible from PIT since the 2022 "Polski Ład" reform
Annual ZUS contribution ceiling	PLN 282,600	Pension/disability contributions stop above this level

Leave Entitlements

Leave Type	Entitlement	Who Pays	Key Condition
Annual Leave	20 days/year (under 10 years' total career) or 26 days (10+ years)	Employer	Based on total career length, not just tenure with current employer
Sick Leave	Up to 33 days/year at 80% pay (employer); ZUS thereafter	Employer (first 33 days) + ZUS	Reduced to 14 days employer-funded for employees 50+
Maternity Leave	20 weeks (longer for multiple births)	ZUS (100% or 80% of salary depending on election)	Can be combined with parental leave up to 41–43 weeks total
Paternity Leave	2 weeks	ZUS (100% of salary)	Must be used before the child turns 12 months

Payroll, Tax & Contributions

Total Cost Example — USD \$3,000 Gross Monthly Salary

Cost Item	Amount (USD)	% of Gross
Gross salary	\$3,000.00	100%
Employer ZUS contribution (illustrative, 20.5%)	\$615.00	20.50%
EOR service fee (HeroForce, Tier 2)	\$600.00	20.00%
Estimated total monthly cost	~\$4,215.00	~140.5%

HeroForce EOR service fee shown at USD \$600 per employee per month (Tier 2 pricing), no setup fee. The employer accident insurance rate (0.67%–3.33%) varies by industry risk classification — this example uses a mid-range office rate. Employee deductions (withheld separately) include ZUS (13.71%), NFZ health (9% of the post-ZUS base) and progressive PIT.

Income Tax (PIT, 2026)

Poland uses a simple two-bracket progressive system with a PLN 30,000 annual tax-free allowance (kwota wolna).

Annual Taxable Income (PLN)	Rate
0 - 30,000	0% (kwota wolna)
30,000 - 120,000	12%
Above 120,000	32%

Employees under 26 are exempt from PIT on employment income up to an annual cap ("zero PIT for youth").

Termination & Separation

Notice Periods

Length of Service	Notice Period	Legal Basis
Under 6 months	2 weeks	Polish Labour Code
6 months - 3 years	1 month	Polish Labour Code
3+ years	3 months	Polish Labour Code

Severance (Odprawa)

Statutory severance applies to employers with 20+ employees under the Collective Redundancy Act (group or individual redundancy for reasons not attributable to the employee).

Length of Service	Severance	Cap
Under 2 years	1 month's pay	Capped at 15× the minimum wage
2 - 8 years	2 months' pay	
8+ years	3 months' pay	

★ HERO TIP

Poland's odprawa severance obligation only applies to employers with 20+ employees under the Collective Redundancy Act — smaller foreign entities hiring through an EOR structure often fall outside this threshold, which materially changes the termination cost picture. Confirm your total Polish headcount with your HeroForce EOR before assuming severance applies.

Public Holidays 2026

Poland observes 13 public holidays in 2026, blending fixed civic/religious dates with the moveable Corpus Christi (60 days after Easter).

Date	Holiday	Type
1 January	New Year's Day	National
6 January	Epiphany	National
6 April	Easter Monday	National
1 May	Labour Day	National
3 May	Constitution Day	National
4 June	Corpus Christi	National
15 August	Assumption Day / Armed Forces Day	National
1 November	All Saints' Day	National
11 November	Independence Day	National
25–26 December	Christmas Day and 2nd Day of Christmas	National

Ready to hire in Poland?

HeroForce by Employment Hero is an Employer of Record solution that handles hiring, contracts, compliance and payroll across 180+ countries.

Onboard your first Poland employee in as little as one to two weeks — HeroForce EOR service fee: **USD \$600** per employee per month, no setup fee (Tier 2).